

79.3 "SOMETHING" AND "ANYTHING"

"Something" and "anything" refer to an unspecified or unnamed object or thing. "Something" can only be used in questions and positive statements, whereas "anything" can be used in negative statements as well as questions and positive statements.

Can I have **something** to eat?

Here "something" refers to a specific, unnamed thing that the speaker has in mind.

Yes, have **something** from the cupboard.

Here "something" has a more general meaning, as the speaker may not have a specific thing in mind.



Is there **anything** I can help with?

The singular form of the verb is used with "anything" and "something."

No, there isn't **anything** you can do.

This statement is negative, so "anything" is used, not "something."



FURTHER EXAMPLES

Have **anything** you want.

"Anything" used in positive statements shows the possibilities are unlimited.



Anything baked by my grandmother tastes delicious.



There's **something** I need to tell you.



We don't have **anything** in common.



Something that I've always enjoyed is kayaking with my friends.



I know I've forgotten **something**, but I can't think what it is.



I'd do **anything** to be able to sing like her.



Something spooky happened last night.

